Cabbage Palm, Sabal Palm

Sabal palmetto

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Overlook: 2 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 20–40 ft (up to 50–70 ft). Confirmed by UF/IFAS (up to 40 ft typical), multiple sources. × 8–20 ft. Crown of fronds.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a (edge). Hardy Zones 8–11. Native to coastal Georgia, South Carolina, Florida. Tall palm with fan leaves. Cold hardy to about 15°F. Performs in Atlanta in protected sites or with microclimate. Drought and salt spray tolerant. State tree of SC and FL. Attractive tropical accent. Slow to moderate growth. Wind tolerant. Restart pass (2026-10-13): UGA cold-protection note (Columbus–Augusta line) already cited. Existing notes stand. UGA (Gary Wade, 2003): cabbage palm usually can be grown without cold protection along a line from Columbus to Augusta; cold protection is best north of that line (Atlanta lies north of it). Recommend planting in a sheltered courtyard or the southeast side of a structure and wrapping the fronds and center bud for temperatures below 25°F. [https://fieldreport.caes.uga.edu/news/cold-hardy-palms-grow-throughout-georgia/]
Sun: Full sun to partial shade.
Water: Low to medium. Drought tolerant once established. Prefers well-drained. Avoid salt in root zone.
Soil: Adaptable, well-drained preferred. Sandy to loam. Coastal soils. Tolerates some wet.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in well-drained soil. Water until established. Suitable as specimen or accent in protected Atlanta sites. Drought tolerant. Minimal pruning (remove dead fronds). Good for coastal or microclimate Atlanta landscapes. Attractive tropical form.
Soil prep: Adaptable, well-drained preferred. Sandy to loam. Coastal soils. Tolerates some wet.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Coastal plains, hammocks, dunes. Southeastern range. State tree of SC and FL.
Form / habit: Palm. Tall single trunk with crown of costapalmate fan leaves. Slow to moderate growth. Upright.
Foliage: Evergreen. No fall color.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Trunk smooth or with persistent leaf bases (bootjacks).
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally resistant to pests and diseases. Possible nutrient deficiencies. Cold damage possible in extreme events, especially for young plants or in unprotected inland sites. UGA note: cold protection recommended for Atlanta (north of the Columbus–Augusta line). [https://fieldreport.caes.uga.edu/news/cold-hardy-palms-grow-throughout-georgia/]
Not stated
Additional:
- Fan-shaped leaves. - Cold hardy for a palm. - Edible heart (cabbage). - Native to coastal Georgia. - Wind and drought tolerant. - Attractive trunk and form.

Sources: - UF/IFAS ENH-733 - Multiple botanical and nursery references - UGA CAES Field Report (Gary Wade, 2003): cold-hardy palms and Columbus–Augus